

Plan of Work

Scholarship Group (Year 8)

Summer Holiday 2026 • Dr Sam Quill

Overview

These classes prepare students for the scholarship examinations at the major public schools — principally Eton, Winchester and Westminster. As the opening block of the year, the summer course introduces students to the format and demands of the scholarship papers and begins the steady work of building the skills they will need: close reading, historical source analysis, essay argumentation, and creative writing.

The programme works systematically through past papers in English and History and also the General II papers from across the schools. The papers are drawn from earlier years, so that the most recent papers remain available for mock conditions later in the year. These are interspersed with skills-focus sessions, which step back from individual papers to develop a particular technique in depth.

After each class I will circulate a document, compiled during the class, with notes on how to answer each question, showing what is necessary to attain full marks. Each class will be followed by a homework task.

My Approach

When a lesson is centred on a paper, we will work through each question by guided group discussion, during which I compile notes on the correct answers. Each class will usually also include an element of writing practice in response to one of the longer questions; we will share writing and I will appraise students' work. The skills-focus sessions are supported with my own selection of materials and exercises, curated to build technique efficiently.

My lessons have two major objectives:

- To encourage students to think at the level the scholarship examinations demand, which is far higher than they are used to in the classroom.
- To teach them how to write those thoughts on paper, articulately and in the context of an exam.

Plan of Classes

Key: White = Past Paper • Yellow = Skills Focus

#	Lesson
1	Past Paper: English (Winchester, 2016)
2	Past Paper: History (Winchester, 2016)
3	Past Paper: General II (Westminster, 2014)
4	Past Paper: English (Westminster, 2015)
5	Past Paper: History (Eton, 2016)
6	Skills Focus: Figurative Language
7	Past Paper: General II (Winchester, 2014)
8	Past Paper: English (Eton, 2016)
9	Past Paper: History (Westminster, 2016)
10	Past Paper: General II (Eton, 2014)
11	Past Paper: English (Westminster, 2016)
12	Past Paper: History (Winchester, 2017)
13	Skills Focus: Structuring Your Writing
14	Past Paper: General II (Westminster, 2015)
15	Past Paper: English (Winchester, 2017)
16	Past Paper: History (Eton, 2017)
17	Past Paper: General II (Winchester, 2015)
18	Past Paper: English (Eton, 2017)
19	Past Paper: History (Westminster, 2017)
20	Skills Focus: Linguistic Ambiguity
21	Past Paper: General II (Eton, 2015)
22	Past Paper: English (Westminster, 2017)
23	Past Paper: History (Westminster, 2018)
24	Past Paper: General II (Westminster, 2016)
25	Past Paper: English (Winchester, 2019)
26	Past Paper: History (Eton, 2018)
27	Skills Focus: Learning from the Great Essayists
28	Past Paper: English (Westminster, 2019)
29	Past Paper: General II (Eton, 2016)
30	Past Paper: English (Eton, 2018)

The Skills Focus Sessions

Four lessons step away from the papers to develop a particular technique in depth. These are detailed below.

#	Session	Description
6	Figurative Language	A workshop on simile, metaphor and related devices — how to identify them precisely in unseen texts and how to deploy them with control in creative writing.
13	Structuring Your Writing	From the sentence to the paragraph to the whole essay — how to order ideas so that an argument is easy to follow and builds to a point.
20	Linguistic Ambiguity	How words and sentences can carry more than one meaning, why this matters in close reading, and how to use and resolve ambiguity in writing.
27	Learning from the Great Essayists	We read short passages by accomplished essayists to see how argument, voice and style work on the page, and what can be borrowed for the students' own writing.

Homework and the Road Ahead

Each class will be followed by a homework task, which will be to complete either a selection of the smaller questions or one of the essay-length answers (this will vary depending on the paper). I will give the students a precise mark and feedback on their homework, so they can keep track of their progress and so that I can become familiar not only with their abilities in speaking but also in writing.

As the year progresses, I like to focus increasingly on writing since that is the format of the exams. However, these summer sessions are also about familiarising students with the style and typical content of the papers, and developing their ability to think about and express ideas beyond the expectations of the classroom, towards the much higher demands of scholarship selection.

~

Yours,

Dr. Sam